to shew their respect to Mr Bonham. During the day the Prince govr sent to me to ask whether he should send all the chief officers of his court to attend the funeral, which I refused as I knew that Mr Bonham wished the ceremony to be as private as possible. On arriving at the Church the coffin was placed in the middle and the service which much resembles the Roman Catholic was performed by the Armenian Priests, and when the coffin was lowered into the grave I read the service according to the rites of our church. Poor Mr Bonham held up pretty well, he had looked on with a sort of vacant stare, but no sooner was this service finished, than he fell down on the floor of the church as if he had been shot. I was afraid of this happening in the streets, where from the inclemency of the weather, and his then state, it might have been dangerous; as it was his friends brought him round as they best could, and partly carried him partly supported him home. I stayed at the church to see that the grave was properly closed in and then returned to Mr Bonhams.

I can not sufficiently praise the conduct of M. d'Ozeroff. I had hitherto known him as a hospitable good tempered man, merry over a glass of wine and always glad to see his friends. To appreciate what he did you must consider that the disease was considered highly contagious by the physician and that in the execution of the duty which he had volunteered to perform, he placed himself in actual danger. With me the case was very different. Had I known that any other could have gone through this work as well as I could, I would have gone from here to Moskow, rather than have had any thing to do with it. With me it was a duty, Bonham is my friend, and therefore what I did was only my duty, and had the disease been the most contagious plague, with which it has ever pleased the Almighty to afflict this earth, *I hope* (for I will not say I am *sure*, no man knows what he will do until he is tried) that I should have done my duty without flinching. But with M. d'Ozeroff it was not a matter of duty, he came and volunteered out of friendship to Mr. Bonham.

*Tabreez, February 18, 1845*

I am affraid I have frightened you with writing in a former letter that I was half a Puseyite.[83] It was not the term I ought to have used, what I meant to say was that I think they are quite right in some things. As to their wearing black gowns or white, or their bowings etc I can not think how a man in his senses can think it worth while disputing about such nonsense. In fact I am *most* liberal about religious matters, much more so than I was when I left England. And can get on just as well with a puritan or quaker as I can with a Catholic or one

[83] Puseyism (sometimes called Newmania) was a High Church reform movement at least indirectly sponsored by Edward Bouverie Pusey, and responsible for many of the eventual reforms within the Church of England.

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